financial assistance of the Government of India and the Government of Gujarat for providing skilled labour for the Industry.

ADVISORY BODIES

Board of Trade (BoT)

The BoT was set up on May 5, 1989 with a view to provide an effective mechanism to maintain continuous dialogue with trade and industry in respect of major developments in the field of International Trade. It meets at least once in a year. The Commerce and Industry Minister is Chairman of the Board. Its official membership includes Secretaries of the Ministries of Commerce and Industry, Finance (Revenue), External Affairs, Textile; Chairman of Indian Trade Promotion Organisation (ITPO), Chairman/ MD of Export Credit and Guarantee Corporation of India Limited (ECGC), MD/Exim Bank and Deputy Governor of Reserve Bank of India. The non-official members are Federation of Indian Chamber of Commerce and Industry (FICCI); Associated Chamber of Commerce and Industry (ASSOCHAM), Confederation of Indian Industry (CII), Federation of Indian Export Organisations (FIEO), All India Handloom Farmers Marketing Cooperative Society, representatives of various Trade and Industry sectors, media and other eminent personalities in the field of export and import trade. The broad terms of reference of the Board of Trade are as follows: To advise the Government on policy measures for preparation and implementation of both short-and long-term plans for increasing exports in the light of emerging national and international economic scenario; To review export performance of various sectors, to identify constraints and suggest measures to be taken both by the Government and the industry/trade consistent with the need to maximise export earnings and restrict imports; To examine the existing institutional framework for exports and suggest practical measures for reorganisation/ streamlining it with a view to ensure co-ordinated and timely decision making; to review the policy instrument, package of incentives and procedures for exports and suggest steps to rationalise and channelise incentives to areas where they are needed the most.